Donovan Ellison

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SKILLS

Programming: Go, Python, CSS, HTML, and JavaScript

Technologies: Ansible, AWS, GCP, Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, and Jenkins

Certifications: GIAC Cloud Security Automation Certification (GCSA)

EXPERIENCE

Security Engineer, *Ontra*

Sep 2024 — Present

- Built an AI vulnerability-triage agent (Claude Code sub-agents, Semgrep and Jira APIs, human approval gate) that drafted decisions on 438 tickets in 6 months as quarterly intake rose ~13x, screening out false positives (60%) before they reached engineering teams.
- Replaced manual vulnerability handoffs with an event-driven pipeline (Tines, Jira automation, Slack) that tracked 1,000+ vulnerability findings from 5+ sources, set SLA due dates, routed vulnerabilities to owning teams and auto-closed 242 tickets on scanner fix or triage events.
- Partnered with Infrastructure on a service-mesh and Gateway API migration for east-west mTLS. Analyzed gateway benchmarks to steer controller selection, co-built Linkerd and Kgateway proofs of concept, and upgraded the Calico operator.
- Owned the Rad Security runtime agent on 10 production and staging AWS EKS clusters, keeping Kubernetes threat detection and audit logging current through 12 merged Helm and Terraform PRs.

Senior Cloud Security Engineer, *apree health*

Mar 2024 — Sep 2024

- Optimized Terraform pipelines, decreasing approval and request processing times by over 80%, enhancing efficiency and usability for both approvers and requesters.
- Partnered with engineering teams to deploy Renovate across 100+ repositories, automating dependency management. This proactive approach mitigated Critical and High vulnerabilities in over 50 production services, significantly enhancing security posture.
- Facilitated the deployment of a self-service access portal, resulting in a 66% reduction in group request completion times and ensuring adherence to SOC II and HITRUST access controls.
- Streamlined and optimized the setup and coordination of AWS and GCP pentests, reducing the overall setup time by 50%.

Cloud Security Engineer, *apree health*

Jan 2022 — Mar 2024

- As the inaugural Cloud Security Engineer, led security initiatives throughout a year-and-a-half long data center migration to GCP.
- Enforced CIS standards with Policy-as-Code for hundreds of GCP projects, ensuring compliance with encryption key usage and preventing misconfigurations such as publicly accessible GCS buckets.
- Successfully implemented egress filtering for URLs in PHI environments, a pivotal step in achieving HITRUST certification.
- Orchestrated the deployment of DiscrimiNAT across 6 VPCs, effectively filtering traffic in 27 environments with over 900 unique FQDNs.
- Developed a Python Flask app that enables developers to bypass the 24-hour SLA for FQDN additions by quickly creating temporary egress firewall rules in lower environments. This innovation saved thousands of engineering hours, allowing uninterrupted development and testing.
- Introduced sprint planning, backlog grooming, and retrospective sessions, resulting in an outstanding 77% reduction in Lead Time for ticket completion, from an average of 61.3 days to just 13.8 days after 3 months.

Site Reliability Engineer, *Zapproved* **Mar 2021 — Jan 2022**

- Enabled AWS Systems Manager for several dozen EC2 instances, providing secure remote command execution, automated patching, and granular access control to instances.
- Architected an AWS solution for managing SSH keys on TeamCity agents across multiple AWS accounts, enhancing security and access management.
- Analyzed and resolved an Elasticsearch cluster issue that caused day long logging outages, sometimes multiple times a week.
- Spearheaded the refactoring of the AWS Elastic Kubernetes Service (EKS) provisioning and configuration.
- Developed a roadmap for Kubernetes improvements by evaluating different tools, researching best practices, creating proof of concepts, and meeting with key stakeholders.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in **Computer Science, University Honors** **Sep 2016 — Aug 2020**

Portland State University